About GuruJal

GuruJal, an Abhipsa Foundation initiative, aims to achieve water neutrality through integrated water resource management. We design and demonstrate innovative and localised solutions for groundwater recharge and management in arid and semi-arid regions of India.

In today's fast-paced world, the bond between humans and nature is gradually fading. With urbanization and technological advancements, many of us have distanced ourselves from the environment that nurtures us. Yet, our connection with nature is not just vital, it is intrinsic to our well-being and survival. This booklet is a heartfelt attempt by GuruJal to rekindle that connection.

Nature offers us solace, beauty, and sustenance. It's the shade of a tree on a hot day, the sound of rustling leaves in the breeze, and the nourishment from the earth beneath our feet. But beyond its gifts, nature is a responsibility, a relationship that requires nurturing and care from our side too.

Through small, meaningful steps, each of us can play a role in restoring this bond. This booklet invites you to step outside, breathe the fresh air, touch the soil, and immerse yourself in the wonders of nature. It encourages you to embrace simple habits that not only bring you closer to the environment but also create lasting positive impacts. It also acts a Knowlegde resource for your brains to contemplate sense, It also provides an interaction with the local hereos who will inspire you to take action.

Let this be your guide to a wholesome journey, one of discovery, joy, and responsibility, where every action brings us closer to a harmonious relationship with nature.

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Chapter 01.

Green Spaces

Green spaces are essential for maintaining ecological balance, offering clean air, and providing a peaceful escape from the city's hustle. Delhi NCR, despite its urban sprawl, is home to several lush parks, forests, and natural retreats that promote biodiversity and well-being..

Green Spaces Near Delhi NCR



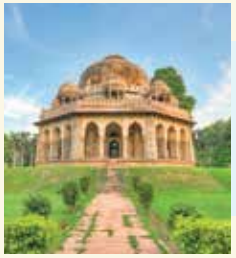
Aravalli Biodiversity Park

Aravalli Biodiversity Park is a restored green space in Delhi, home to native plants and wildlife. It offers peaceful trails and promotes ecological awareness.

Vijay Mandal Park

Vijay Mandal Park is a peaceful green space in South Delhi, ideal for morning walks, casual sports, and family outings amidst lush trees and open lawns.





Lodhi Garden

Lodhi Garden is a serene historical park in the heart of Delhi, dotted with centuries-old tombs and lush greenery, offering a peaceful escape from the city's hustle.

Damdama Lake

Damdama Lake is a serene natural reservoir near Gurgaon, surrounded by the Aravalli Hills, known for its peaceful ambiance, adventure activities, and scenic beauty.



Urban Gardening: Cultivating Green Spaces in Cities

Urban gardening is growing plants in cities, on rooftops, balconies, backyards, and schools. It fosters sustainability, enhances food security, and connects people to nature. Here are popular types to inspire your green journey:



Backyard Gardens

Grow fresh greens at home by turning unused spaces into productive plots. Enjoy homegrown food and share surplus with neighbors, fostering community bonds.



Rooftop Gardens

Turn your rooftop into a green haven! Beautify the city, regulate temperature, support wildlife, and grow food, all while maximizing urban space.



Vertical Gardens

Perfect for small spaces, vertical gardens grow plants on walls or structures, adding greenery indoors or outdoors.



Container Gardening

Grow plants in pots or tubs, perfect for patios and balconies. A flexible, beginner-friendly way to add color to small spaces.



Hydroponics

Plants grow in nutrient-rich water, eliminating soil. This high-tech method maximizes yields in minimal space, ideal for



Community Gardens
Community gardens unite people to grow food and greenery, fostering teamwork, fresh produce access, and stronger neighborhood bonds.

Ground Heroes Near You

There are numerous organizations and spaces in Delhi-NCR dedicated to promoting organic, sustainable, and community-based practices, encouraging individuals to embrace a more natural and healthy living.

Edible routes (Delhi)
Edible Routes is one of India's largest organic farming organizations. We set up kitchen gardens, rent out farmland for urban growers, conduct workshops on organic farming & sustainability and sell natural farming products.

Farmus (Gurgaon)
From sustainable organic farming to connecting the consumers, producers and enterprises together into a single community, they wish to make the food ecosystem Sustainable, Transparent and Traceable.

The Prodigal Farms (Noida)
Their goal is to reconnect people with real food by growing seasonal produce through natural farming, crafting artisanal products, teaching farming as a life skill, serving farm-to-fork meals, and offering zero-waste farm experiences and workshops.

Online Inspiration

Spreading the message of green living and fostering a love for gardening, below are some online indian spaces which can be a great way to start your own personal journey.

Garden Up
From a social media sensation to a gardening brand, Garden Up continues its mission of inspiring green living, empowering individuals to create their own green spaces for well-being and sustainability.

The Prakriti's Garden
It was launched in 2017 to share gardening knowledge and support plant enthusiasts.their own, ultimately leading to a Green, healthy & Happy Earth.

Walks around Delhi NCR

Green	Timings	About the Green Spaces
Lodhi Garden media	(Monday - Sunday 6 AM - 8 PM)	This lush park in the heart of Delhi is home to birds like black drongos, treepies, mynahs, and red-vented. bulbuls.
Aravali Biodiversity Park.	(Monday-Sunday-6–11am, 3–7pm)	The Aravalli Biodiversity Park aims to restore Delhi's lost biodiversity and promote environmental awareness.
Hauz Khas Park	(Monday to Saturday 10:30 AM to 8:00 PM)	This region is known for its lush greenery, roaming deer, peacocks, diverse bird species, and other small mammals.
Sanjay Van.	(Monday to Saturday 5 AM–7 PM)	Enter via Qutub Institutional Area or Neela Hauz Bridge, and carry essentials as there are no shops inside.
Panchsheel Forest.	(Monday - Saturday 5 AM - 10 AM & 4 PM - 7 PM)	A serene 2.5 km trail with trees, a Bhairav Mandir, and dancing peacocks in season.
Asola Bhatti Wildlife Sanctuary.	(Monday to Saturday 6 AM - 2 PM)	Asola-Bhatti Wildlife Sanctuary is a unique urban reserve in the Aravallis with national ecological significance.
Kamla Nehru Ridge.	(Monday to Saturday 5 AM - 10 AM & 4 PM - 7 PM)	Once a site of the 1857 revolt, the Northern Ridge is now restored, reviving its Aravalli ecology and role in groundwater recharge.

Chapter 02.

Waste

Introduction

Waste refers to any material that is no longer needed or usable in its current form. While often discarded, waste can be a valuable resource if managed properly. Waste is generally categorized into:

Types :

a. Organic Waste: Food scraps, garden waste, and biodegradable materials.
b. Recyclable Waste: Paper, cardboard, glass, metals, and certain plastics.
c. Hazardous Waste: Batteries, chemicals, electronic waste, and medical waste, which require careful disposal.

Small Steps to Reduce Waste from Your Lifestyle



Adopt Minimalism
Buy only what you need and focus on quality over quantity.



Say No to Single-Use Items
Carry reusable bags, bottles, and containers.



Plan Your Meals
Reduce food waste by buying only what you can consume and repurposing



Embrace DIY
Make your own cleaning products, candles, or cosmetics to cut down on packaging waste.



Swap and Share
Exchange items like books, clothes, and tools instead of buying new



Go Paperless
Opt for digital bills, invitations, and notes.



Compost Organic Waste
Turn kitchen scraps into nutrient-rich compost for your garden.

Ideas to Reduce Waste

Reduce
1. Buy grains & spices in bulk to cut packaging waste.
2. Choose unpackaged produce or shop at farmer's markets.
3. Use loose-leaf tea instead of tea bags.

Reuse
1. Use cloth bags instead of plastic.
2. Repurpose old clothes into rags or bags.
3. Make eco-friendly cleaners with vinegar and baking soda.

Recycle
1. Compost food scraps to reduce landfill waste.
2. Sort and clean recyclables properly.
3. Go digital to cut paper waste.



Ground Heroes Near You

Eco-Champions/ Waste Warriors/ Green Guardians/ Sustainability Scouts.

E Waste Recycle Hub
A recycling company in Gurgaon that offers a Green Earth program.

Greenshield Enviro
A solid waste management service in Delhi and Greater

Goonj
Goonj bridges urban-rural equity by repurposing cloth for develop-

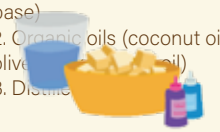
Sahas Zero Waste
A Bengaluru NGO since 2001, diverts 53,000 kg of waste daily.

DIY Steps to make Organic Soap at Home

Making organic soap at home is a fun and creative process. Here's a step-by-step guide to crafting your soap using natural ingredients.

Materials Required

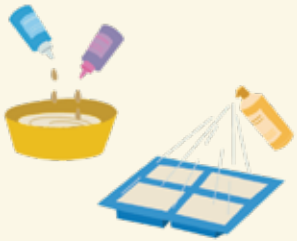
1. Organic soap base (such as glycerin or shea butter soap base)
2. Organic oils (coconut oil, olive oil)
3. Distilled water



Steps to Make Organic













DIY Steps to make Organic Soap at Home

Making organic soap at home is a fun and creative process. Here's a step-by-step guide to crafting your soap using natural ingredients.

Ingredients

Steps to Make Organic Soap

DIY Steps to make Organic Soap at Home

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Ingredients

Steps to Make Organic Soap

Chapter 03.

Composting

Composting is nature's way of recycling, where your kitchen waste becomes a treasure for the earth. By simply turning food scraps into rich, fertile compost, you're not just reducing waste, you're nurturing the planet! This small step of transforming organic matter into valuable soil can have a huge impact on our environment.

"Waste less, grow more!" Let's embrace community composting and feel the magic of getting our hands in the dirt, creating something useful, and connecting with nature. Ready to start your own composting journey? "Turn trash into treasure, and watch the earth bloom!"

Nature vs. Chemicals: Know the Difference!
Chemical Fertilizer vs. Organic Compost: What's Better?

Compost



A substance that provides specific nutrients to plants for faster growth.

Can be synthetic (chemical-based) or organic (e.g., manure, bone meal).

Supplies nutrients directly to plants.

Contains specific ratios of NPK – Nitrogen, Phosphorus, and Potassium.

Offers quick, visible results.

Fertilizer



Naturally decomposed organic material that enriches soil.

Made from plant waste, kitchen scraps, manure, and garden trimmings.

Improves soil fertility, structure, and water retention.

Nutrient content is variable but naturally balanced.

Overuse can degrade soil health and create long-term dependency.

Can lead to water pollution and harm beneficial microbes.

Synthetic fertilizers can be expensive.

Best for rapid plant growth, but should be used with caution to avoid long-term harm.

Must be applied in measured amounts for targeted plant needs.

Boosts microbial activity in the soil.

Eco-friendly and sustainable – reduces waste and emissions.

Cost-effective, often made at home.

Mixed with soil to enhance it naturally.

Acts slowly but offers long-term benefits.

A sustainable solution for healthy, fertile soil and ecological balance.

How to make Compost from Kitchen Waste?

Choose a Bin – Use a bin, container, or garden corner with aeration holes.

Collect Waste – Add fruit peels, veggie scraps, eggshells, coffee grounds, and tea leaves. Avoid dairy, meat, oily food, and excess citrus.

Balance Greens & Browns – Use 2 parts browns (dried leaves, cardboard) to 1 part greens (kitchen scraps, grass clippings).

Layer Properly – Start with browns, then greens, and repeat.

Aerate Regularly – Turn the pile every few days to speed up decomposition and prevent odor.

Keep It Moist – Maintain a damp sponge-like consistency; sprinkle water if needed.

Wait & Monitor – In 4-6 weeks, compost will be dark, crumbly, and earthy-smelling.

Use It – Mix with soil or mulch plants for healthy growth!

Chapter 04.

Connect with Nature

Individuals/ Organisation dedicated to environmental education and conservation

Gurujal Nature Walks : GuruJal conduct various walks in Aravalli.

Sunil Harsana walks - He conducts walks in Faridabad and Gurugram Aravalli while sharing the knowledge about nature.

Dilli Meri Jaan- They conduct the Nature and heritage walks in Delhi and its Region.

Community Activities

Step outside, explore, and connect with nature firsthand. Whether solo or with loved ones, immerse yourself in its wonders. Take the leap, become a changemaker, and share this gift with your community!



Rain Painting

Rain painting is a fun, hands-on STEAM activity for kids on a rainy day, indoors or outdoors. They enjoy watching their colorful art transform in the rain.

1. Have children draw or paint on heavyweight watercolor paper using watercolor pencils, markers, or paints. Remind them that the final artwork will change.

2. Place the artwork in the rain and observe how the colors blend and shift.

3. Carefully bring the wet artwork inside to dry.

4. Hold it flat to prevent dripping, as rain paintings can get messy.



Herbarium Art

Herbarium art combines plant collecting, pressing, and cataloging with creative expression.

1. Uses real pressed plants like flowers, leaves, ferns, and mosses for artistic compositions.

2. Collect something unique from the farm without harming nature.

3. Press it between books/diaries for at least 30 minutes. (Full drying takes 5+ days, but we'll use it today.)

4. Check if it's ready; then start creating.

5. Paste it onto paper and present it creatively.

6. Share your work and, if you want, talk about your creation!

Human Sundial

The human sundial helps all ages understand the sun's movement and time, blending ancient knowledge with modern curiosity. It uses a person as a shadow-casting object to tell time by noting where their shadow falls on an elliptical dial.

1. Choose a sunny, open spot like a playground, driveway, or rooftop patio.

2. Mark an 'X' where the child will stand as the needle.

3. Trace their shadow with chalk at least three times—morning, midday (solar noon), and late afternoon.

4. Encourage children to describe their shadows and predict their next position.



Mud Art

Mud art uses natural mud, clay, or earth to create visual art.

1. Have you noticed the different types of soil around us? Collect various colors and bring them to your station in 15 minutes.

2. Strain the mud through a strainer to remove rocks and wood pieces.

3. Keep the refined mud in a cup and add water to make a smooth, liquid-like texture.

4. Let's make brushes! Take a twig, break one end, and with help, slice it to a point. To make it bushy, smash it with a stone.

5. Now, let's color! Grab the paper in front of you, bring your colors, and start drawing with your brush.



Guardians of Damdama

A Journey of Water Conservation.



Suraj (16) and his sister Sonali (12) lived in the village of Damdama near the once-beautiful Damdama Lake. Their grandfather, Dadaji, often shared stories of the lake's past—sparkling waters, cool breezes, and lush greenery. But now, the lake was dry and cracked.
One hot afternoon, as they stared at the near-empty lakebed, Sonali wondered aloud what had happened. Dadaji explained, "People waste water and pollute the lake. Back in our time, we respected it."

Inspired, Suraj said, "Let's try to save the lake!" Dadaji encouraged them, reminding them that even small efforts matter. The siblings rallied their friends, and with Dadaji's help, they made a plan:

1. Fix leaks and avoid wasting water.
2. Use only as much water as needed
3. Put up signs and organize lake clean-ups
4. Set up rainwater harvesting barrels
5. Plant trees to cool the area

Soon, the village began to change. People fixed leaks, stopped dumping trash, and joined clean-ups. The children were proudly called "The Lake Heroes."
Eventually, the rains returned, and the lake slowly filled again. Dadaji hugged the kids. "With care and effort, even dry lands can bloom again," he said.
Their story spread across neighboring villages, inspiring others to protect nature and make a difference, one small step at a time.



Sounds of the Aravalli

A Young Explorer's Tale.

Twelve-year-old Jeevan, curious and adventurous, lived near Kherla School and loved exploring his village. One sunny afternoon, near the ancient Baba Baldas Mandir in the Aravalli hills, he heard a strange sound. Chasing it through the trees, he discovered a stunning purple-blue bird perched on a branch, its feathers sparkling in the sun. Though he didn't know its name, the moment stayed with him.

Days later, Mukul Sir, a nature expert, visited Jeevan's school to teach about the Aravallis. Describing the region's rich biodiversity, he called it "a natural library of life and sound." During a fun game called "Guess the Sound," one bird call caught Jeevan's attention—it was the same one he'd heard near the temple! Excited, he asked about it.

"That's the purple sunbird," Mukul Sir said, "a vital pollinator and one of the Aravalli's brightest gems." Jeevan felt proud to learn its name and role in nature. Inspired, he began exploring the hills with fresh curiosity, listening closely to the sounds of the wild.

From that day, Jeevan became a young guardian of the Aravallis, eager to protect and celebrate its beauty.

Chapter 06.

Activities

WAYNE DROP'S CROSSWORD PUZZLE

ACROSS

2) Keep water in the _____ when playing, it will save water.

4) Visit wateruseitwisely.com for 100+ Water-Saving _____.

6) Turn off the _____ tightly after each use.

9) At home or while staying in a hotel, reuse your _____.

10) If you accidentally drop _____ cubes, don't throw them in the sink. Drop them in a house plant instead.

DOWN

1) Use a _____ instead of a hose to clean patios, sidewalks and driveways, and save water every time.

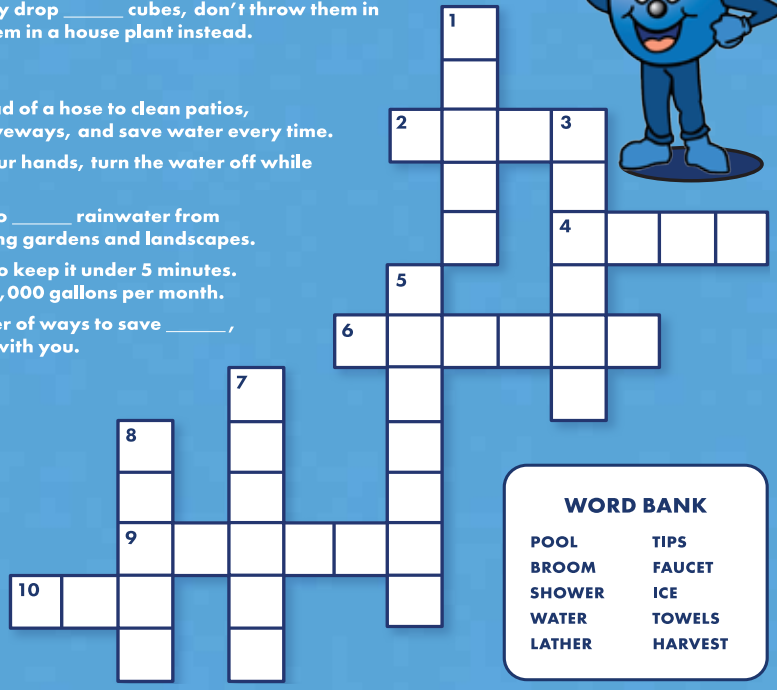
3) When washing your hands, turn the water off while you _____.

5) Use a rain barrel to _____ rainwater from gutters for watering gardens and landscapes.

7) Time your _____ to keep it under 5 minutes. You'll save up to 1,000 gallons per month.

8) There are a number of ways to save _____, and they all start with you.





WORD BANK

POOL	TIPS
BROOM	FAUCET
SHOWER	ICE
WATER	TOWELS
LATHER	HARVEST

WATER USE IT WISELY

Visit WaterUseItWisely.com for 100+ water-saving tips.

A	G	V	E	A	W	A	I	O	N	C	D	R	O	U	G	H	T	Q	R
G	F	S	D	R	J	H	B	K	E	S	R	U	C	Y	T	Z	M	A	L
P	R	E	C	I	P	I	T	A	T	I	O	N	V	D	Y	A	N	S	W
T	Z	O	N	S	I	B	M	L	U	A	P	O	N	A	R	Q	D	D	P
O	M	H	U	F	E	S	C	I	D	N	L	F	S	P	B	I	U	F	E
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E	L	T	Z	A	R	G	D	A	T	E	N	M	G	I	J	R	L	M	Y
V	L	C	B	L	S	L	I	B	B	A	S	H	A	A	R	G	C	S	B
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aquifer
condensation
drink
drought
evaporation
fuel
groundwater
irrigate
permeable
pollution
precipitation
recharge
runoff
saturation zone
spring
well

THE GROUNDWATER FOUNDATION